

Banality shows the extent to which the character has been tainted by the mundane world.

The three Traits are expressed differently from others in that they utilize a split scoring system. Each one has both a permanent and a temporary score. The permanent score, referred to as *rating*, shows the character's total potential and is measured in *dots*. The temporary score is concerned with the current state of her being, is called the character's *pool* and is measured in *points*. Points can be gained or lost without affecting the overall rating. When Temper Traits are rolled, use the rating as a dice pool, regardless of the current pool.

When you create a character, you assign her Temper ratings. These are based on her seeming and any freebie points spent on the Trait. The character's Willpower and Glamour pools start with points equal to the rating; Banality starts with an empty pool. A Temper's rating and pool can both fluctuate in play, but the rating only changes in response to very significant events, while the pool changes much more often.

CONVERTING POINTS

Characters may never have more temporary Glamour or Willpower points than their permanent ratings. Think of your permanent score as a cap on the total points that character may have in that rating. This is not true for Banality; its pool can rise as high as 10.

If the character has lost or used all his temporary points in Glamour or Willpower, he may choose to convert a dot into a number of points equal to his new rating. If he has 5 dots of Glamour and his pool falls to zero, he may convert one of his Glamour dots into four new temporary points, and now has a Glamour rating of 4. This usually isn't very efficient, as raising Glamour and Willpower with experience points is expensive and recovering points is easy enough to do in play, but in a life-or-death situation the character might have little choice.

Banality works differently. If the character exceeds 10 points of Banality, a reverse conversion takes place. When the character gains what would be an 11th point of Banality, her pool empties and the Banality rating rises by one dot. A character's Banality rating may never rise more than one dot at a time, regardless of how many temporary points are gained to push the character's rating above 10. If a character has Banality 3 and nine points, and then gains two more points, she now has Banality 4 and an empty pool.

Willpower

A character's Willpower represents her control over herself. Is she facing opposition? She uses her strength of will to overcome it. Does someone try to manipulate her or tempt her into something enticing but dangerous? Willpower allows her to resist that temptation or to throw off suggestions or coercions.

Using Willpower

- A Willpower point purchases a single success on a dice roll. You may only spend one point per roll, but that guarantees a single automatic success (which also reduces the chance



Willpower

Ratings

•	Weak
• •	Timid
• • •	Unassertive
• • • •	Diffident
• • • • •	Certain
• • • • • •	Confident
• • • • • • •	Determined
• • • • • • • •	Controlled
• • • • • • • • •	Iron-Willed
• • • • • • • • • •	Unshakeable



of a botch). The Storyteller may prohibit this use in certain situations.

- The player can spend a point of Willpower to let a character avoid an instinctive reaction, allowing her to overcome phobias, control her emotions, or counter imposed commands or suggestions for a short time (i.e., enough to apply to the situation at hand). The player spends a point to ignore the compulsion and do as she pleases. This can be a long, drawn out, and difficult contest, but sooner or later the character's Willpower will give out. Note that Willpower may not be used to counteract a magical compulsion.
- Willpower can sometimes either contain or control the effects of Bedlam. Spending a Willpower point lets the changeling ignore Bedlam's irrationality and weird perceptions. It cannot cure Bedlam but can lessen the effects and allow the changeling to regain some modicum of sanity for a short time.

Recovering Willpower

Willpower dots may only be purchased with experience points. Refreshing the Willpower pool, on the other hand, can be effected in a number of ways:

- When a story ends, all the characters refill their Willpower pools.
- After a good night's sleep in which the character dreamed peacefully and without interruption, the character feels invigorated. When that happens, he regains a Willpower point. If his sleep is disturbed — by bad dreams or by an interruption — he might not gain the point, at the Storyteller's discretion. Unless this is a planned part of the story, Storytellers should usually let the characters sleep well. Otherwise, it becomes too hard for characters to replace lost Willpower.
- The Storyteller may award Willpower points for the character's accomplishment of a goal related either to the current story or quest or by fulfilling her primary Legacy. The Storyteller may award from one to five points (depending on how grand the task).